

Whose teeth?

These teeth belonged to a full-grown sperm whale. Sperm whales have the largest teeth of all the toothed whales. They grow up to 8 in (20 cm) in length.

A sperm whale only has teeth in its lower jaw.

The crabeater seal's teeth close to form a sieve that filters food from the water.

All the better to eat you

A seal doesn't chew. It uses its teeth to grasp and bite, and it will swallow its prey whole. Seals hunt and eat in water.



Not all the same

Seals and sea lions have a range of different teeth, just like us. This crabeater seal shows its incisors, canines, and jagged cheek teeth (which are adapted premolars and molars).

Canine tooth

How old?

It is possible to tell the age of some whales and seals by looking at cross-sections of their teeth. Just like a tree, one ring means one year of growth.

